

Stage 3: pupa

When the caterpillar is big enough, it sheds its skin, fastens itself to a plant stem and creates a pupa – a hard shell – around itself.

Stage 4: adult

Inside the pupa an amazing change takes place. Eventually, it splits open and the butterfly emerges.

The caterpillar has to find a safe place to make its pupa.

When it's ready, the butterfly pumps fluid around its body to help split the shell.

The butterfly must wait for its wings to flatten out and dry before it can fly away.

A pupa can remain like this for weeks or even months.

Ladybirds

Like butterflies, ladybirds go through metamorphosis.



Eggs: the female lays a group of eggs on a leaf.



Larva: the eggs hatch out into larvae, called nymphs.



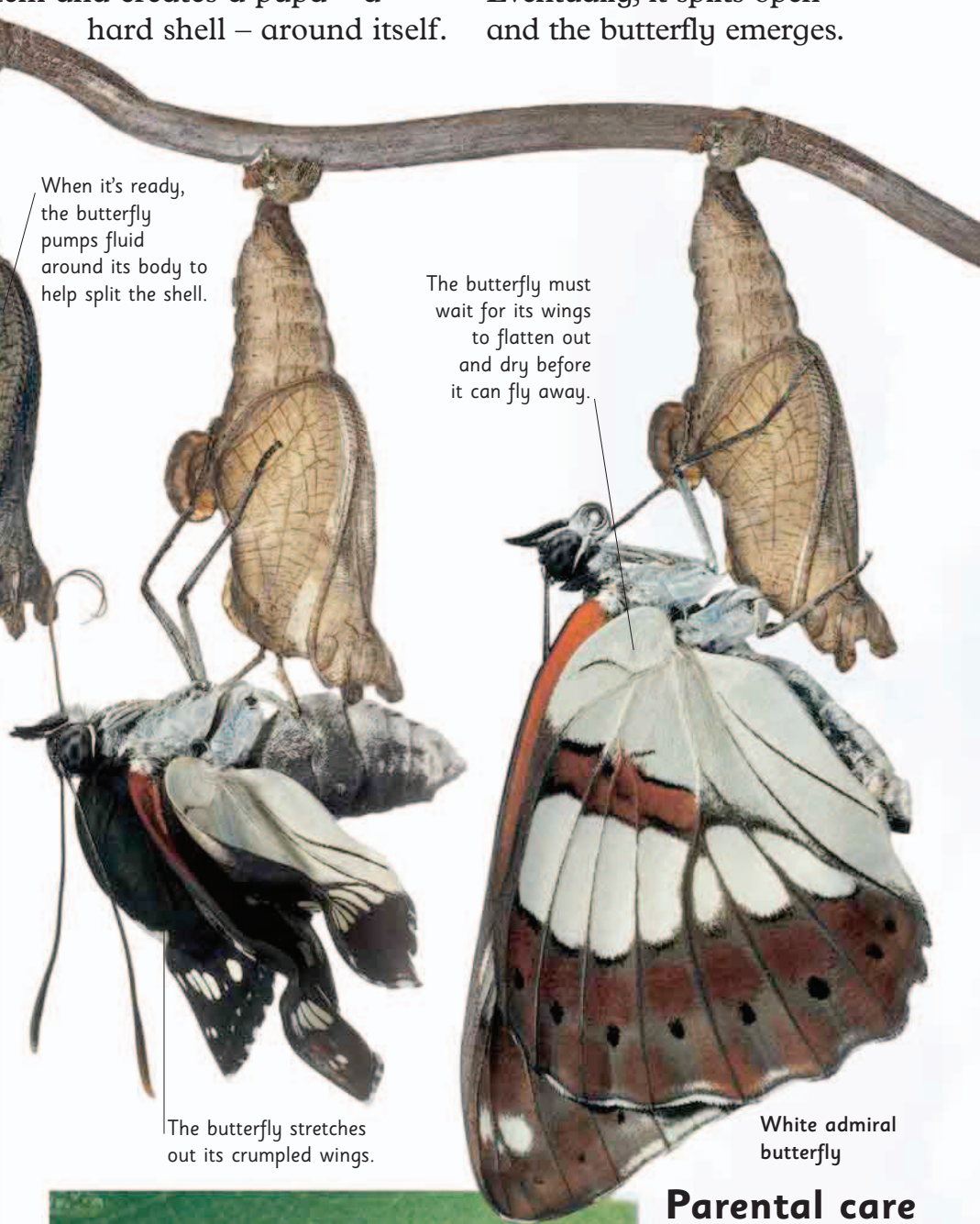
Pupa: a month after hatching, each larva builds itself a pupa.



Young ladybird: A week later, a yellow adult emerges.



Adult: After a while the yellow colour turns to red with black spots.



The butterfly stretches out its crumpled wings.

White admiral butterfly



Parental care

Most insects abandon their eggs after they have laid them. However, unlike others, shield bugs care for and fiercely protect their babies.